In the previous example,where 'fire' is accepted as the proximate cause of loss and if there is no fire and goods are destroyed due to excessive heat, the insurance company would not be liable to pay compensation.

5. Contribution

The same subject matter may be insured with more than one insurer then it is known as 'Double Insurance'. In such a case, the insurance claim to be paid to the insured must be shared on contributed by all insurers in proportion to the sum assured by each one of them. It may be noted that in case of multiple insurance, the insured can claim the loss from any of the insurers subject to the condition that the insured cannot recover more than the amount of actual loss from all taken together.

Example: A businessman gets his factory insured against fire for ₹10,00,000 with insurer A and ₹5,00,000 with insurer B. Due to fire, a loss of ₹1,50,000 occurred. Then, insurers A and B will contribute the loss in the ratio of 2:1. A will pay ₹1,00,000 and B will pay ₹ 50,000.

6. Subrogation

Subrogation means 'stepping the shoes on others'. According to this principle, once the claim of the insured has been settled, the ownership right of the subject matter of insurance passes on to the insurer. Otherwise, the insured will realize more than the actual loss which goes against the principle of Indemnity. This is because the insured cannot make any profit by selling the damaged property

Example: Mr. B gets his motor car insured. Some of its parts got damaged at a road accident. He gets the insurance claim and gets the damaged parts replaced with new ones. In this case the damaged parts will be taken by the insurance company. The insured has no right over the damaged parts since they had already got compensation for the damaged parts.

7. Mitigation

In case of a mishap, the insured must take off all possible steps to reduce or mitigate the loss or damage to the subject matter of insurance. This principle ensures that the insured does not become negligent about the safety of the subject matter after taking the insurance policy. Insured is expected to act in a manner as if the subject matter has been insured. If appropriate steps are not taken to save the property then the insured may not get the full compensation from the insurer.

Example: When a factory is insured against fire and theft by insured, insured must take all possible precautions and steps to prevent those from the risk.

15.03 Types of Insurance

Insurance covers different types of risks. All contracts of insurance can be broadly classified as follows:

1. Life Insurance (or) Life Assurance
2. Non-life Insurance (or) General Insurance

It can be further classified into: (i) Fire Insurance; (ii) Marine Insurance; (iii) Health Insurance and (iv) Miscellaneous Insurance.

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